



Cover Letter & Executive Summary

*Fede Analytics — Response to the Financial Intelligence Centre (FIC) Request for Bid: **Azure-Based Analytics Support***

Cover Letter

From: Fede Analytics Company Registration No.: **2023/724375/07** CSD Supplier No.: **MAAA1671295** Physical Address: **1 Juta Street, Braamfontein, Johannesburg, 2001** Postal Address: **1 Juta Street, Braamfontein, Johannesburg, 2001**
To: Ms Keneilwe Masemene Supply Chain Management Financial Intelligence Centre (FIC) Email: Tenders@fic.gov.za

Date: **06 August 2026**

Re: Request for Bid — Azure-Based Analytics Support (Support and Maintenance of Custom Analytics Solutions on Microsoft Azure)

Dear Ms Masemene,

Fede Analytics is pleased to submit its bid in response to the FIC's Request for Bid for **Azure-Based Analytics Support**. We have read and understood the requirements of the RFB and confirm our commitment to delivering the three-year managed support service and on-demand maintenance described in the bid document.

We are an operator-led data-engineering and governance partner specialising in Microsoft Azure and Databricks. Our practice is built on hands-on delivery and maintenance of production analytics platforms — Azure Synapse Analytics, Azure Databricks, Azure Data Lake Storage (ADLS) Gen2, Azure Key Vault, Microsoft SQL Server, and Python-based analytics, ETL, and orchestration — combined with a disciplined approach to data governance and secure operations. This is precisely the capability the FIC requires to keep its custom analytics solutions performant, secure, cost-optimised, and continuously improved.

We understand that the FIC operates in a security-sensitive government context where the confidentiality and integrity of financial-intelligence systems are paramount. We confirm our willingness to comply fully with the FIC's security, governance, confidentiality, and reporting requirements, including the special conditions set out in the RFB.

This bid pack contains our executive summary, company profile and credibility evidence, technical approach, service delivery model and SLA, track record and reference letters, proposed resource pool and CVs, security and special-conditions responses, pricing schedule, and the mandatory compliance forms and traceability documentation.

We confirm that all information provided in this submission is true and correct to the best of our knowledge, and that the authorised signatory below is empowered to bind Fede Analytics to the terms of this bid.

This offer is valid for 90 (ninety) days from the closing date of the bid.

We welcome the opportunity to support the FIC in safeguarding the integrity of South Africa's financial system and remain available to clarify any aspect of our submission.

Yours faithfully,

Samuel Sephiri Co-Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Fede Analytics Email: samuel.sephiri@fedeanalytics.com Tel: **+27 78 021 1187**

Executive Summary

The FIC's need

The FIC's mandate is to safeguard the integrity of South Africa's financial system by combating money laundering, the financing of terrorism, and related financial crime. Its analytics capability — the custom solutions built on Microsoft Azure — is core operational infrastructure supporting that mandate. Those solutions must remain available, performant, secure, and cost-efficient over the three-year term, while evolving as intelligence needs change. This bid responds directly to that need: a reliable managed support service backed by on-demand enhancement and skills transfer, delivered by specialists who operate Azure and Databricks platforms every day.

Why Fede Analytics

Fede Analytics is an **operator-led** partner: we do not simply advise on Azure data platforms, we build, run, and maintain them. Our differentiators map directly to the FIC's requirements:

- **Databricks Lakehouse and LLM certifications** — underpinning expert support of Azure Databricks, Delta Lake, clusters, jobs, and notebooks in the FIC estate.
- **Google Cloud data-engineering credentials** — evidencing platform-agnostic depth in data engineering, pipelines, and orchestration that transfers directly to Azure Synapse, ADLS Gen2, and Python-based ETL.
- **CARAT governance framework** — our structured approach to data governance, controls, and secure, auditable operations, aligned to the FIC's security-sensitive environment.
- **A deployed, agnostic Ontology Lakehouse platform** — a production architecture integrating **Azure Databricks + Neo4j + dbt** that turns data into an **ontology-driven knowledge graph**. This makes *relationships* — entities, accounts, transactions, and the

links between them — first-class, queryable, and explainable, directly serving financial-intelligence work such as entity resolution and network/link analysis. Built on open formats, it keeps the FIC free of vendor lock-in.

- **AI Excellence framework** — a disciplined model for delivering and maintaining analytics and AI capability responsibly and to measurable standards.
- **QCTO / MICT SETA accredited training** (accreditation no. **07-QCTO/SDP120426232821**) — accredited skills-transfer capability that directly serves the RFB's on-demand user-training, adoption, and knowledge-transfer deliverables.
- **15+ years of founder experience** across banking, fintech, and telecommunications — sectors with the same regulatory rigour, data sensitivity, and operational-reliability expectations as the FIC.
- **600+ FTEs trained across seven countries** — demonstrated reach and repeatability in building client data capability, reducing the FIC's long-term dependency on external support.

Leadership

Fede Analytics is led by **Samuel Sephiri (Chief Executive Officer)**, whose background includes serving as **Head of Decision Science (Fintech) at MTN**, with senior data and analytics leadership experience at **Mr Price** and **FNB**. This is leadership grounded in large-scale, regulated, financially-sensitive data environments — the same operating conditions the FIC works within — ensuring the engagement is guided by people who understand both the technology and the governance stakes.

Fit for a security-sensitive government context

We recognise that supporting the FIC's platforms means working with highly sensitive information. Our CARAT governance framework, secure operating practices, and willingness to meet the RFB's confidentiality, vetting, and citizenship conditions position us to operate inside the FIC's security perimeter with the discipline the mandate demands. We commit to the FIC's business hours, reporting cadence, and dual-site coverage (Centurion and Cape Town) as detailed in our service delivery model.

Commercial commitment

Our pricing is structured to the RFB Section 8 format across all three years — a lean managed-service retainer plus a market-competitive on-a-need-basis hourly rate within the 288-hour annual cap — all inclusive of VAT. **This offer is valid for 90 (ninety) days from the closing date of the bid.**

Fede Analytics is ready to be the FIC's trusted Azure and Databricks support partner, combining deep engineering capability, governance discipline, explainable knowledge-graph and ontology practice, and accredited skills transfer in service of the FIC's financial-intelligence mandate.

